THE SECOND EPISTLE OF

PETER

Address and Salutation. "Be not idle nor unfruitful." "We were Eyewitnesses of his Majesty"

1 [1] Simon Peter, a [2] [a] servant and [b] apostle of Jesus Christ, to them that have obtained [3] a [c] like precious faith with us in [d] the righteousness of [4] [e] our God and *the* Saviour Jesus Christ: 2 [f] Grace to you and peace be multiplied in [g] the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord; 3 seeing that his [h] divine power hath granted unto us all things that pertain unto life and godliness, through the [g] knowledge of him that [i] called us [5] by his own glory and virtue; 4 whereby he hath granted unto us his precious and exceeding great [k] promises; that through these ye may become [l] partakers of [6] the divine nature, having [m] escaped from the [n] corruption that is in [o] the world by lust. 5 Yea, and for this very cause adding on your part all diligence, in your faith [p] supply [q] virtue; and in *your* virtue [r] knowledge; 6 and in *your* knowledge [s] self-control; and in *your* self-control [7] [t] patience; and in *your* [7] patience [u] godliness; 7 and in *your* godliness [8] [v] brotherly kindness; and in *your* [8] brotherly kindness love. 8 For if these things are yours and abound, they make you to be not idle nor [x] unfruitful unto [g] the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ. 9 For he that lacketh these things is [y] blind, [9] seeing only what is near, having forgotten the [z] cleansing from his old sins. 10 Wherefore, brethren, give the more diligence to make your [a] calling and [b] election sure: for if ye do these things, ye shall never [c] stumble: 11 for thus shall be [d] richly [e] supplied unto you the entrance into [f] the eternal kingdom of our [g] Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

12 Wherefore [h] I shall be ready always to put you in remembrance of these things, though ye know them, and are established in [i] the truth which is with *you*. 13 And I think it [k] right, as long as I am in [l] this tabernacle, to [m] stir you up by putting you in remembrance; 14 knowing that [n] the putting off of my tabernacle cometh swiftly, [o] even as our Lord Jesus Christ signified unto me. 15 Yea, I will give diligence that at every time ye may be able after my [10] [p] decease to call these things to remembrance. 16 For we did not follow cunningly devised [q] fables, when we made known unto you the [r] power and [11] coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but we were [s] eyewitnesses of his majesty. 17 For he [12] received from God the Father honor and glory, when there was borne such [t] a voice to him by the [u] Majestic Glory, This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased: 18 and this voice we *ourselves* heard borne out of heaven, when we were with him in the [v] holy mount. 19 And we have [z] the word of prophecy *made* more [y] sure; whereunto ye do well that ye take heed, as unto [z] a lamp shining in a [13] dark place, until the [a] day dawn, and the [b] day-star arise [c] in your hearts: 20 [d] knowing this first, that [e] no prophecy of scripture is of [14] private interpretation. 21 For [f] no prophecy ever [15] came by the will of man: but men spake from God, being [g] moved by the Holy Spirit.

[1] Many ancient authorities read *Symeon*. See Acts 15. 14.
[2] Gr. *bondservant*.
[3] Gr. *an equally precious*.
[4] Or, *our God and Saviour* Comp. ver. 11; 2. 20; 3. 18; Tit. 2. 13.
[5] Some ancient authorities read *through glory and virtue*.
[6] Or, *a*
[7] Or, *stedfastness*
[8] Gr. *love of the brethren*.
[9] Or, *closing his eyes*
[10] Or, *departure*
[11] Gr. *presence*.
[12] Gr. *having received*.
[13] Gr. *squalid*.
[14] Or, *special*
[15] Gr. *was brought*.

[a] Rom. 1. 1; Phil. 1. 1; Jude 1; comp. Jas. 1. 1
[b] 1 Pet. 1. 1
[c] Rom. 1. 12; 2 Cor. 4. 13; comp. Tit. 1. 4
[d] Comp. Rom. 3. 21–26
[e] See Tit. 2. 13
[f] 1 Pet. 1. 2; see Rom. 1. 7
[g] ver. 3, 8; ch. 2. 20; 3. 18; comp. Jn. 17. 3; see Phil. 3. 8
[h] Comp. 1 Pet. 1. 5
[i] Comp. 1 Th. 2. 12; 2 Th. 2. 14; 1 Pet. 5. 10
[k] Comp. ch. 3. 9, 13
[l] Comp. Eph. 4. 13, 24; Heb. 12. 10; 1 Jn. 3. 2
[m] ch. 2. 18, 20
[n] ch. 2. 19
[o] See Jas. 1. 27
[p] Comp. ver. 11
[q] Comp. ver. 3
[r] Col. 2. 3; comp. ver. 2
[s] See Acts 24. 25
[t] See Lk. 21. 19
[u] Comp. ver. 3
[v] See Rom. 12. 10, 1 Pet. 1. 22
[x] Col. 1. 10
[y] Comp. 1 Jn. 2. 11
[z] Eph. 5. 26; see Tit. 2. 14
[a] See Rom. 11. 29; comp. ver. 3; see Mt. 22. 14
[b] Comp. 1 Th. 1. 4
[c] Jude 24; comp. ch. 3. 17; see Jas. 2. 10
[d] See Rom. 2. 4; 1 Tim. 6. 17
[e] Comp. ver. 5
[f] See 2 Tim. 4. 18
[g] ch. 2. 20; 3. 18
[h] Jude 5; comp. Phil. 3. 1; 1 Jn. 2. 21
[i] Comp. Col. 1. 5f.; 2 Jn. 2
[k] Phil. 1. 7
[l] See 2 Cor. 5. 1, 4; ver. 14
[m] ch. 3. 1
[n] Comp. 2 Tim. 4. 6; 2 Cor. 5. 1
[o] Comp. Jn. 13. 36; 21. 19
[p] Lk. 9. 31
[q] See 1 Tim. 1. 4; comp. ch. 2. 3
[r] Comp. Mk. 13. 26; 14. 62; 1 Th. 2. 19
[s] Mt. 17. 1 ff.; Mk. 9. 2 ff.; Lk. 9. 28 ff.
[t] Mt. 17. 5; Mk. 9. 7; Lk. 9. 35
[u] Comp. Heb. 1. 3
[v] Comp. Ex. 3. 5; Josh. 5. 15
[x] 1 Pet. 1. 10 f.
[y] Comp. Heb. 2. 2
[z] 2 Esdr. 12. 42; comp. Ps. 119. 105
[a] Lk. 1. 78
[b] Rev. 22. 16
[c] 2 Cor. 4. 6
[d] ch. 3. 3
[e] Comp. Rom. 12. 6
[f] Comp. Jer. 23. 26; 2 Tim. 3. 16
[g] 1 Pet. 1. 11; comp. 2 S. 23. 2; Lk. 1. 70; Acts 1. 16; 3. 18

False Teachers and Bondservants of Corruption warned against

2 But there arose [a]false prophets also among the people, as [b]among you also there shall be [c]false teachers, who shall [d]privily bring in [1][e]destructive heresies, [f]denying even the [g]Master that [h]bought them, bringing upon themselves swift destruction. 2 And many shall follow their [i]lascivious doings; by reason of whom [k]the way of the truth shall be [l]evil spoken of. 3 And in [m]covetousness shall they with [n]feigned words [o]make merchandise of you: [p]whose sentence now from of old lingereth not, and their destruction slumbereth not. 4 For [q]if God spared not angels when they sinned, but [2]cast them down to [3]hell, and [r]committed them to [4]pits of darkness, to be reserved unto judgment; 5 and spared not [s]the ancient world, but preserved [t]Noah with seven others, [5]a preacher of righteousness, when he brought a [u]flood upon the world of the ungodly; 6 and [v]turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes condemned them with an overthrow, having made them an [w]example unto those that should [x]live ungodly; 7 and [z]delivered righteous Lot, sore distressed by the [a]lascivious life of [b]the wicked 8 (for that [c]righteous man dwelling among them, in seeing and hearing, [6]vexed *his* righteous soul from day to day with *their* lawless deeds): 9 [d]the Lord knoweth how to deliver the godly out of temptation, and to keep the unrighteous under punishment unto [e]the day of judgment; 10 but chiefly them that [f]walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement, and [g]despise dominion. Daring, [h]self-willed, they tremble not to [i]rail at [7]dignities: 11 [k]whereas angels, though greater in might and power, bring not a railing judgment against them before the Lord. 12 But [l]these, as creatures without reason, [m]born [8]mere animals [9]to be taken and destroyed, railing in matters whereof they are ignorant, shall in their [10]destroying surely be destroyed, 13 suffering wrong as [n]the hire of wrong-doing; *men* that count it pleasure to [o]revel in the [p]daytime, spots and blemishes, [q]revelling in their [11]deceivings [r]while they feast with you; 14 having eyes full of [12]adultery, and that cannot cease from sin; [s]enticing [t]unstedfast souls; having a heart exercised [u]in covetousness; [v]children of cursing; 15 forsaking [w]the right way, they went astray, having followed [x]the way of Balaam the *son* of [13]Beor, who loved [y]the hire of wrong-doing; 16 but he was rebuked for his own transgression: [z]a dumb ass spake with man's voice and stayed the madness of the prophet. 17 These are [a]springs without water, and mists driven by a storm; [b]for whom the blackness of darkness hath been reserved. 18 For, uttering [c]great swelling *words* of [d]vanity, they [e]entice in the lusts of the flesh, by [f]lasciviousness, those who are just [g]escaping from them that live in error; 19 promising them liberty, while they themselves are bondservants of corruption; for [h]of [14]whom a man is overcome, of the same is he also brought into bondage. 20 For if, after they have [i]escaped the defilements of the world through [k]the knowledge of [15]the [l]Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, they are again [m]entangled therein and overcome, [n]the last state is become worse with them than the first. 21 [o]For it were better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than, after knowing it, to turn back from [p]the holy commandment [q]delivered unto them. 22 It has happened unto them according to the true proverb, [16]The dog turning to his own vomit again, and the sow that had washed to wallowing in the mire.

[1] Or, *sects of perdition*
[2] Or, *cast them into dungeons* [3] Gr. *Tartarus.*
[4] Some ancient authorities read *chains.* Comp. Wisd. 17. 17. [5] Gr. *a herald.*
[6] Gr. *tormented.* [7] Gr. *glories.* [8] Gr. *natural.*
[9] Or, *to take and to destroy*
[10] Or, *corruption* Comp. 1 Tim. 6. 9.
[11] Some ancient authorities read *love-feasts.* Comp. Jude 12. [12] Gr. *an adulteress.*
[13] Many ancient authorities read *Bosor.*
[14] Or, *what*
[15] Many ancient authorities read *our.*
[16] Prov. xxvi. 11.

[a] Dt. 13. 1 ff.; Jer. 6. 13, &c.
[b] Comp. 1 Tim. 4. 1; see Mt. 7. 15
[c] 2 Cor. 11. 13
[d] Gal. 2. 4; Jude 4
[e] Comp. 1 Cor. 11. 19; Gal. 5. 20
[f] Jude 4
[g] Rev. 6. 10
[h] See 1 Cor. 6. 20
[i] Comp. Gen. 19. 5 ff.; Jude 4; ver. 2, 7, 18
[k] Comp. Acts 16. 17; 22. 4; 24. 14
[l] (Gr.) Rom. 2. 24; 1 Tim. 6. 1
[m] ver. 14; see 1 Tim. 6. 5; comp. Jude 16
[n] Comp. Rom. 16. 18; ch. 1. 16
[o] Comp. 2 Cor. 2. 17 marg.; 1 Th. 2. 5
[p] Comp. Dt. 32. 35
[q] Comp. Gen. 6.; Jude 6
[r] Comp. Rev. 20. 1 f.
[s] ch. 3. 6; comp. Ezek. 26. 20
[t] See 1 Pet. 3. 20
[u] ch. 3. 6
[v] Gen. 19. 24; Jude 7
[w] Jude 7; Mt. 10. 15; 11. 23; Rom. 9. 29 (Is. 1. 9)
[x] Comp. Jude 15
[z] Gen. 19. 16, 29; Wisd. 10. 6
[a] ch. 3. 17
[b] Wisd. 19. 17; comp. Heb. 11. 4
[c] 1 Cor. 10. 13; comp. Rev. 3. 10
[d] See Mt. 10. 15; Jude 6
[e] ch. 3. 3; Jude 16, 18
[f] Jude 8; comp. Ex. 22. 28
[g] Tit. 1. 7
[h] Jude 9
[i] Jude 10
[k] Comp. Jer. 12. 3; Col. 2. 22
[l] ver. 15
[m] See Rom. 13. 13
[n] Comp. 1 Th. 5. 7
[o] Jude 12; comp. 1 Cor. 11. 21
[p] ver. 18
[q] Comp. Jas. 1. 8; ch. 3. 16
[r] See ver. 3
[s] Comp. Eph. 2. 3
[t] Comp. Acts 13. 10
[u] Num. 22. 5, 7; Dt. 23. 4; Neh. 13. 2; Jude 11; comp. Rev. 2. 14
[v] ver. 13
[x] Num. 22. 21, 23, 28, 30 f.
[y] Comp. Jude 12
[z] Jude 13
[a] Jude 16
[b] See Eph. 4. 17
[c] See ver. 2
[d] ver. 20; see ch. 1. 4
[e] Rom. 6. 16; see Jn. 8. 34
[f] See ver. 18
[g] See ch. 1. 2
[h] ch. 1. 11; 3. 18
[i] 2 Tim. 2. 4
[k] Mt. 12. 45; Lk. 11. 26
[l] Comp. Ezek. 18. 24, Heb. 6. 4 ff., 10. 26 f.; Jas. 4. 17
[m] ch. 3. 2, comp. Gal. 6. 2, 1 Tim. 6. 14
[n] Jude 3

Mockers and their Destiny. "The Day of the Lord will come as a Thief." Exhortation to Stedfastness. Doxology

3 This is now, [a]beloved, the second epistle that I write unto you; and in both of them I [b]stir up your sincere mind by putting you in remembrance; 2 that ye should [c]remember the words which were spoken before by [d]the holy prophets, and [e]the commandment of the Lord and Saviour through your apostles: 3 [f]knowing this first, that [1g]in the last days [h]mockers shall come with mockery, [i]walking after their own lusts, 4 and saying, [k]Where is the promise of his [2l]coming? for, from the day that the fathers [m]fell asleep, all things continue as they were [n]from the beginning of the creation. 5 For this they wilfully forget, that there were heavens from of old, and an earth [o]compacted out of water and [3]amidst water, [p]by the word of God; 6 by which means [q]the world that then was, being overflowed with water, [r]perished: 7 but [s]the heavens that now are, and the earth, by the same word have been [4]stored up for [t]fire, being reserved against [u]the day of judgment and destruction of ungodly men.

8 But forget not this one thing, [a]beloved, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and [v]a thousand years as one day. 9 [x]The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some count slackness; but [y]is longsuffering to youward, [z]not wishing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance. 10 But [a]the day of the Lord [b]will come as a thief; in the which [c]the heavens [5c]shall pass away with a great noise, and the [5d]elements shall be dissolved with fervent heat, and [e]the earth and the works that are therein shall be [6]burned up. 11 Seeing that these things are thus all to be dissolved, what manner of persons ought ye to be in *all* holy living and godliness, 12 [f]looking for and [7]earnestly desiring the [2]coming of the day of God, by reason of which [g]the heavens being on fire shall be dissolved, and the [5d]elements shall melt with fervent heat? 13 But, according to his [g]promise, we look for [h]new heavens and a new earth, [i]wherein dwelleth righteousness.

14 [k]Wherefore, [l]beloved, seeing that ye look for these things, give diligence that ye may be [m]found in peace, [n]without spot and blameless in his sight. 15 And account that the [o]longsuffering of our Lord is salvation; even as [p]our beloved brother Paul also, [q]according to the wisdom given to him, wrote unto you; 16 as also in all *his* epistles, speaking in them of [r]these things; [s]wherein are some things hard to be understood, which the ignorant and [t]unstedfast wrest, as *they do* also [u]the other scriptures, unto their own destruction. 17 Ye therefore, [z]beloved, knowing *these things* beforehand, [v]beware lest, being carried away with [x]the error of [y]the wicked, ye [z]fall from your own stedfastness. 18 But grow in the grace and [a]knowledge of our [b]Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. [c]To him *be* the glory both now and [8]for ever. Amen.

[a] ver. 8, 14, 17; see 1 Pet. 2. 11
[b] ch. 1. 13
[c] Jude 17
[d] Lk. 1. 70; Acts 3. 21; comp. Eph. 3. 5
[e] ch. 2. 21; comp. Gal. 6. 2; 1 Tim. 6. 14
[f] ch. 1. 20
[g] See 1 Tim. 4. 1; comp. Heb. 1. 2
[h] Jude 18
[i] See ch. 2. 10
[k] Comp. Is. 5. 19; Jer. 17. 15; Ezek. 11. 3; 12. 22, 27; Mal. 2. 17; Mt. 24. 48
[l] Comp. ver. 12; see 1 Th. 2. 19
[m] See Acts 7. 60
[n] See Mk. 10. 6
[o] Col. 1. 17 (Gr.); Ps. 24. 2; 136. 6
[p] Gen. 1. 6, 9; Heb. 11. 3
[q] Comp. ch. 2. 5
[r] Gen. 7. 21 f.
[s] ver. 10, 12
[t] Comp. Is. 66. 15; Dan. 7. 9 f.; see 2 Th. 1. 7; Heb. 12. 29
[u] See Mt. 10. 15; 1 Cor. 3. 13; Jude 7
[v] Ps. 90. 4
[x] Hab. 2. 3; Heb. 10. 37; comp. Rom. 13. 11
[y] Comp. Rom. 2. 4; Rev. 2. 21
[z] 1 Tim. 2. 4; Rev. 2. 21, Wisd. 11. 23
[a] See 1 Cor. 1. 8
[b] See 1 Th. 5. 2; comp. Mt. 24. 43; Rev. 3. 3; 16. 15
[c] Mt. 24. 35; Rev. 21. 1
[d] Is. 34. 4; comp. 24. 19; Mic. 1. 4, &c.; see Gal. 4. 3 marg.
[e] ver. 7
[f] See 1 Cor. 1. 7
[g] Is. 65. 17; 66. 22
[h] Rev. 21. 1; comp. Rom. 8. 21
[i] Is. 60. 21; 65. 25; comp. Rev. 21. 27
[k] Comp. ch. 1. 10; 1 Cor. 15. 58
[l] See ver. 1
[m] Comp. 1 Pet. 1. 7
[n] Phil. 2. 15; 1 Tim. 6. 14; Jas. 1. 27; see 1 Th. 5. 23
[o] See ver. 9
[p] Comp. Acts 9. 17; 15. 25; ch. 3. 2
[q] 1 Cor. 3. 10; Eph. 3. 3
[r] Comp. ver. 14
[s] Comp. Heb. 5. 11
[t] See ch. 2. 14
[u] Comp. Is. 28. 13; ver. 2
[v] 1 Cor. 10. 12
[x] Comp. ch. 2. 18
[y] ch. 2. 7
[z] Rev. 2. 5
[a] See ch. 1. 2
[b] ch. 1. 11; 2. 20
[c] See Rom. 11. 36; comp. 2 Tim. 4. 18; Rev. 1. 6

1 Gr. *in the last of the days.*
2 Gr. *presence.*
3 Or, *through*
4 Or, *stored with fire*
5 Or, *heavenly bodies*
6 The most ancient manuscripts read *discovered.*
7 Or, *hastening*
8 Gr. *unto the day of eternity.* Ecclus. 18. 10.